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TRAIN-THE-TRAINER SERIES · SESSION 6 OF 8

Building workflows

Turn a repeat task into a fixed pipeline: same steps every run, a check on every output, and a person before anything ships.



7–minute video | Stage 3 | Guide 5.1 · 5.2

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TODAY

By the end, your learners can…

1. Tell a workflow from a chatbot and an agent
2. Pick a good first workflow
3. Chain saved prompts into fixed steps with a check and a review
4. Run it safely: container, logs and limits

CHAPTERS · 7 MIN

drawn to scale



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WHY THIS MATTERS

Most repeat work needs a fixed path, not a smarter chat

01

“We paste the same prompt every Monday”

A repeat task done by hand, a little differently each time, by whoever remembers.

02

“It broke and nobody noticed”

Workflows fail quietly when inputs change, unless something checks the output.

03

“We can’t get agents approved”

You don’t need them yet. Chat plus an API is enough for working automation.

The question for this session:

How do we turn a repeat task into a safe, fixed pipeline?

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CHATBOT, WORKFLOW, AGENT

Who picks each step?

Chatbot

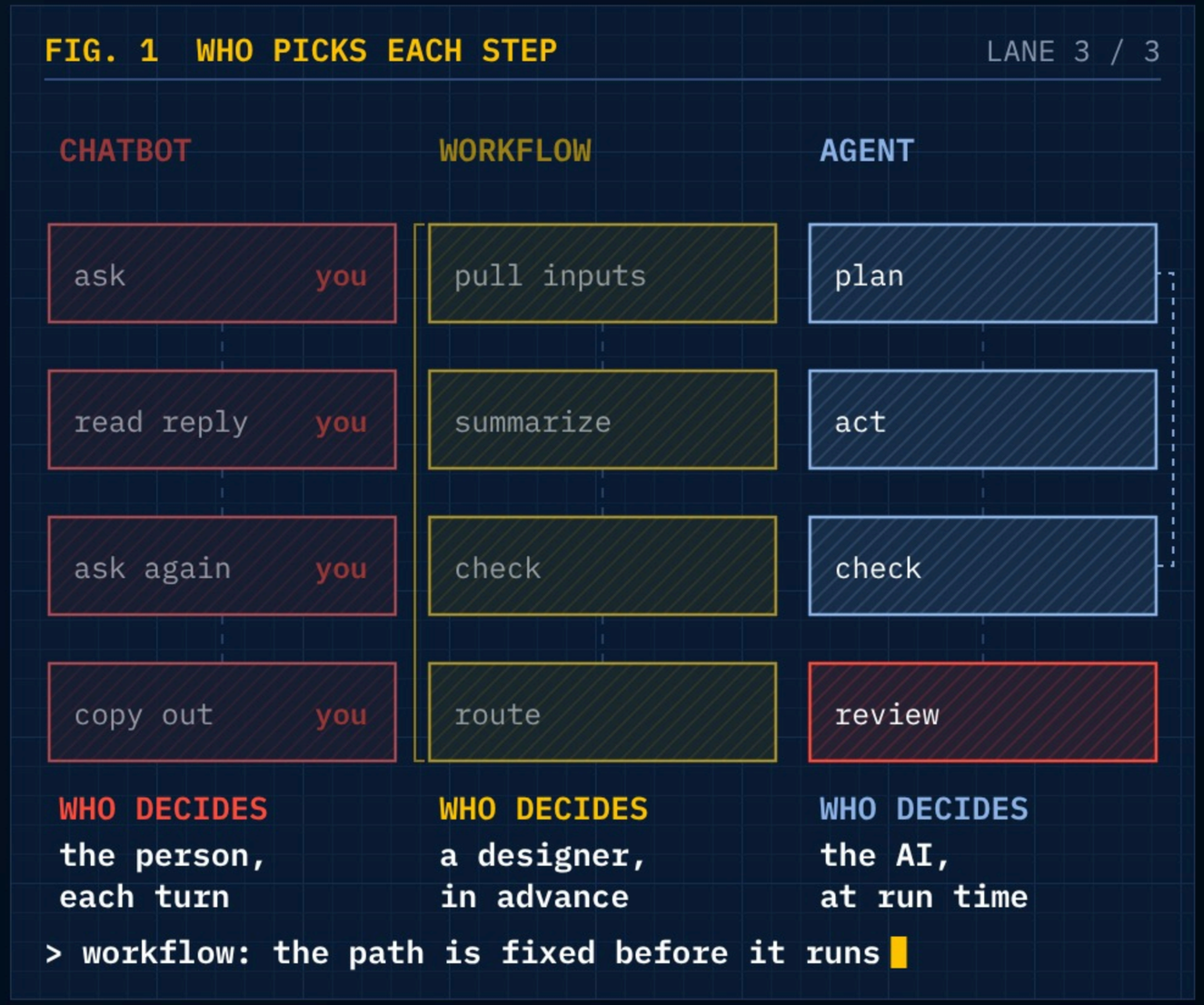
The person, one message at a time

Workflow

A designer, in advance: the same path every run

Agent

The AI, at run time, toward a goal, then a person reviews



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WHAT IS AVAILABLE TODAY

Your environment decides how far you can climb

STAGE 5	**Full harness** Tools, skills and agents, with human approval gates	
STAGE 4	**+ tool calling** The model can look things up or take approved actions	
STAGES 2–3	**Chat + API** Scripted or low-code workflows; MCP servers (connectors that fetch data from another system) as fixed steps	WORKING AUTOMATION · STOP HERE
STAGE 1	**Chat only** Manual prompting, shared templates, copy-paste steps a person runs	

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PICK A FIRST WORKFLOW

Score your task: six signs it’s ready

Start boring
Weekly, same shape every time, a known-good output

Keep what’s safe
Already reviewed, at an approved data level

Prove it
Time it by hand first, then per run



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ANATOMY OF A WORKFLOW

Six fixed steps, including one check and one person

Saved prompts, not typed ones

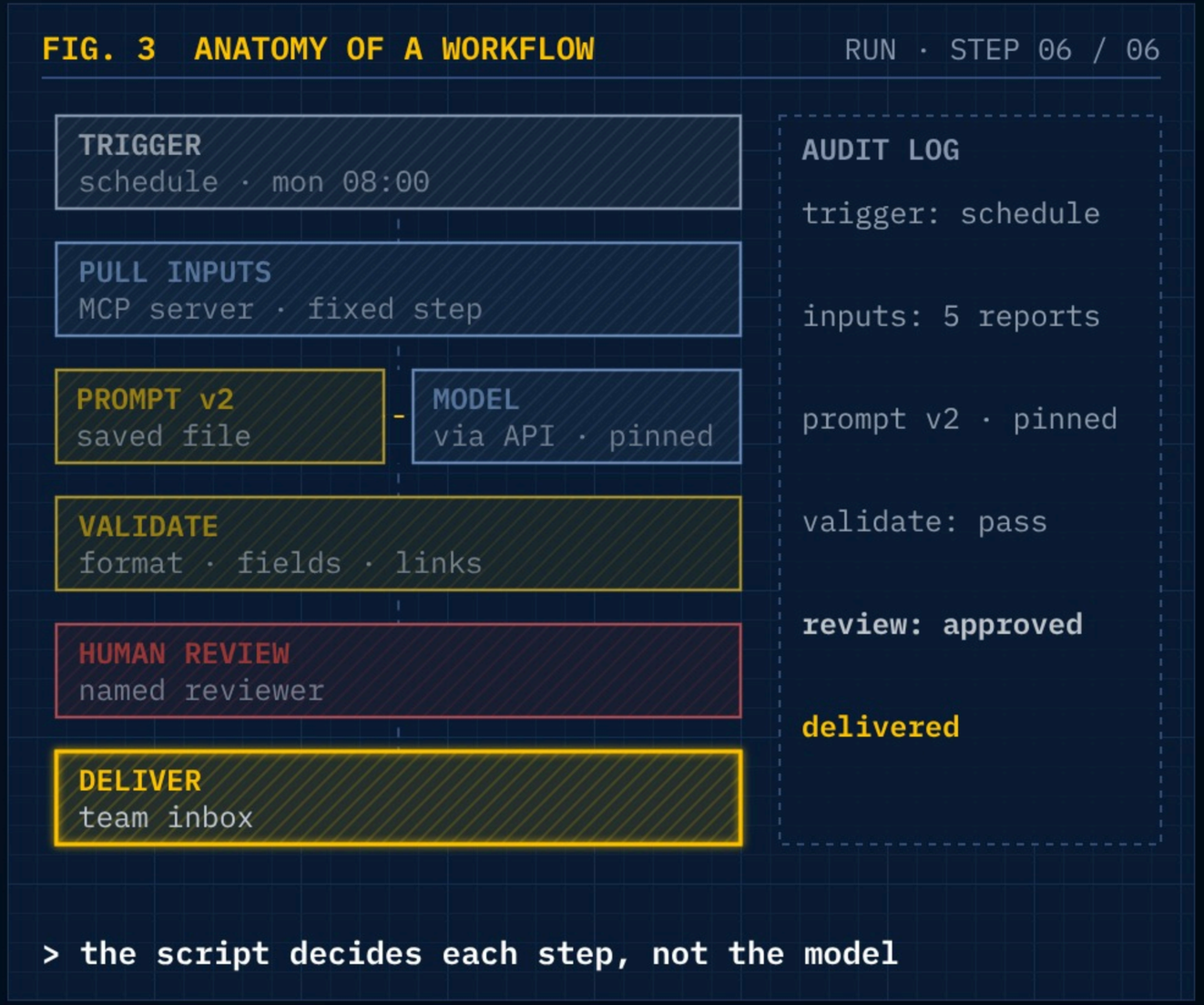
Versioned, reviewed files in a shared, approved location

Inputs through fixed steps

MCP servers pull inputs and deliver results when the script says so

Every step logged

Versions, reviewer, inputs and outputs, at the data level approved for the tool



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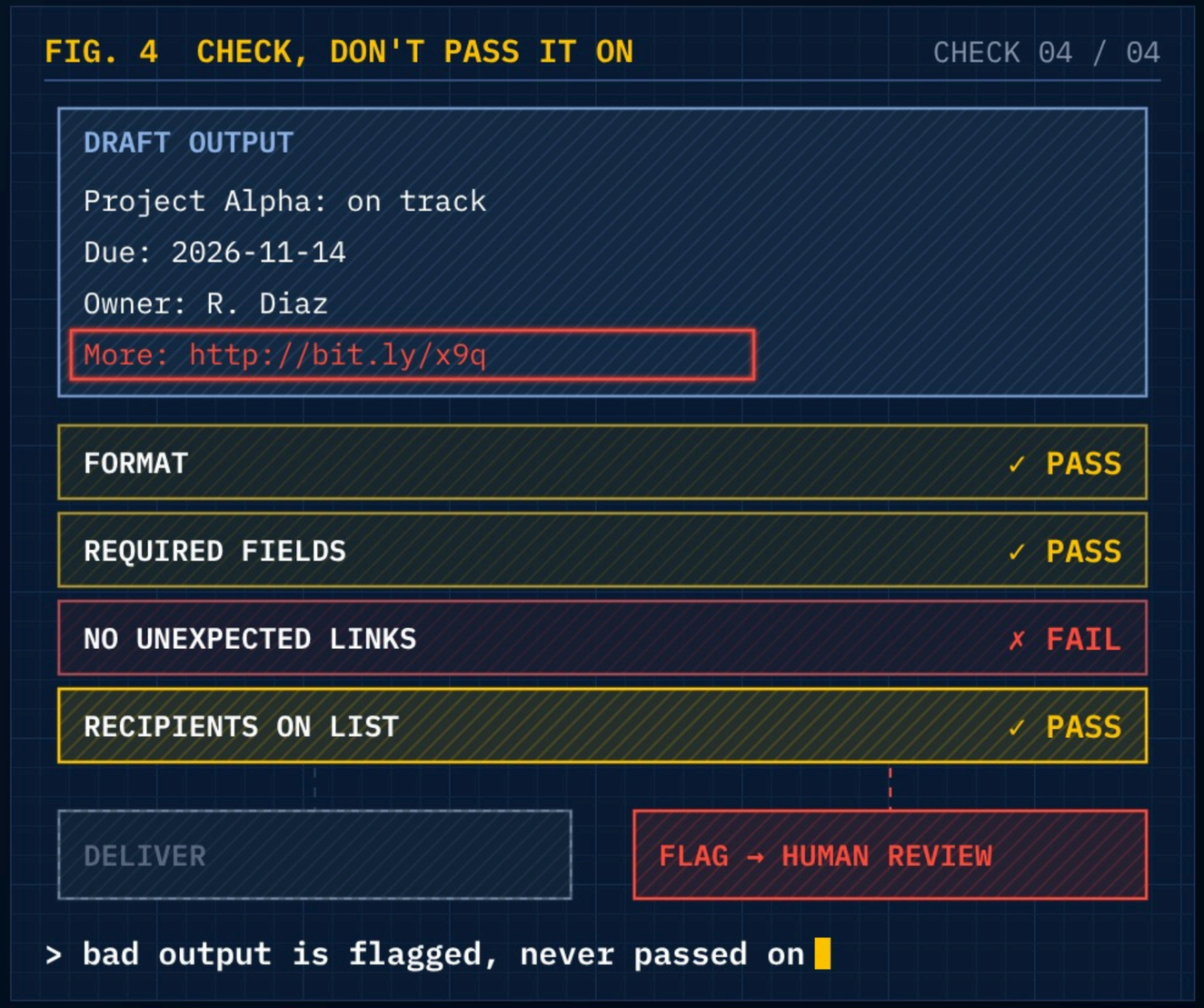
VALIDATION

Check every output before it moves on

Format and fields
The shape you expect, with every required field

No surprises
No unexpected links, recipients or instructions

Flag, don’t pass
A failed check stops the run and routes it to a person



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RUN IT SAFELY

Sealed in, logged, and capped

Container + allow-list

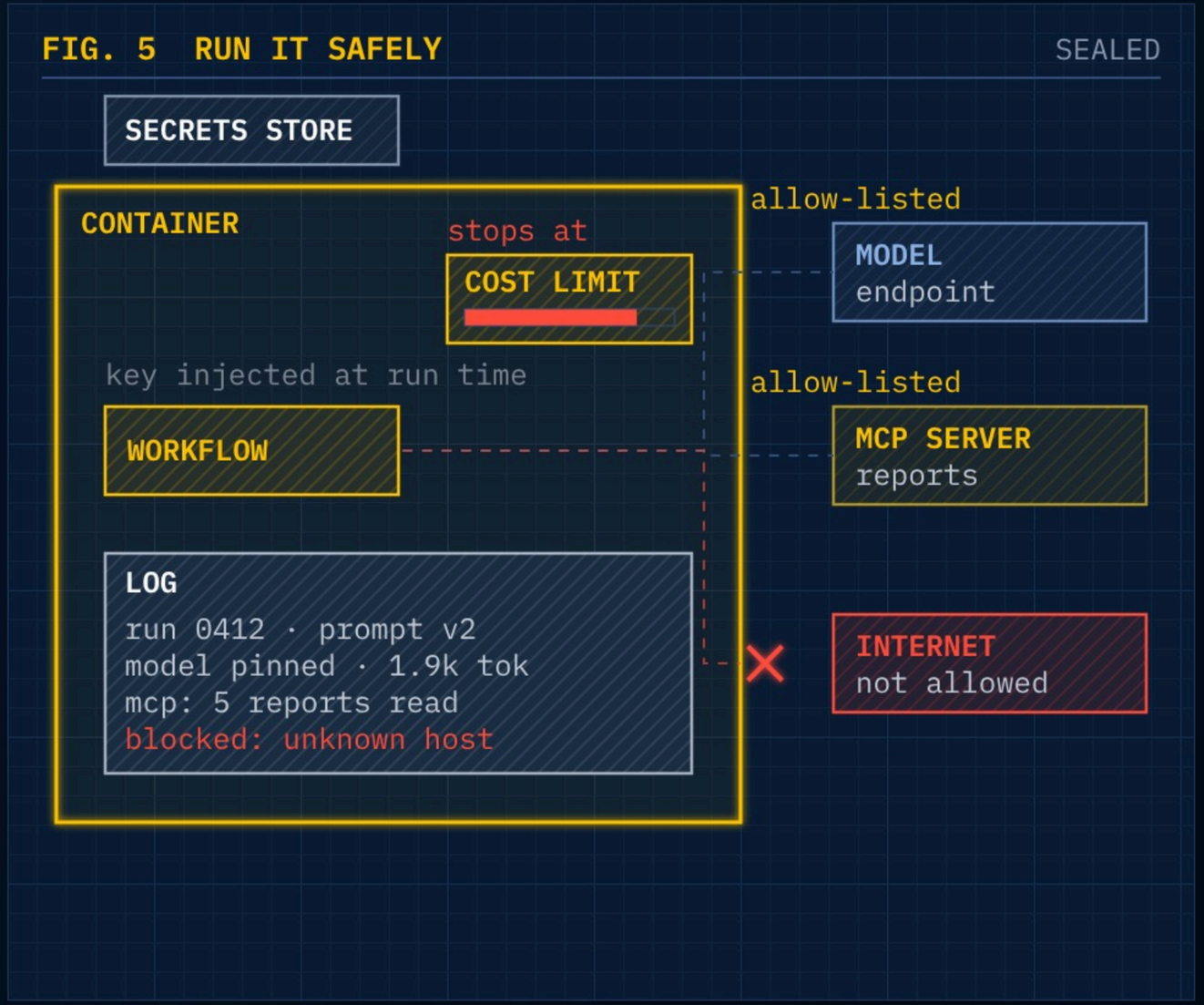
It reaches only the model endpoint and its MCP servers

Logs and limits

Every run logged; cost and rate limits stop a runaway loop

Config and secrets (Session 5)

Endpoint from config, key from the secrets store



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BEFORE RELEASE

Test it, then version it

A test set per prompt

Five known-good cases and one tricky case, such as a planted instruction

A new version is a new release

Never an edit in place; the log records the release

Re-test on any change

A new prompt or a new model version runs the test set again



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MEASURE IT

Four numbers prove the workflow is working

TIME SAVED / RUN

Time the task by hand first, then time each run

ERRORS CAUGHT

Count the corrections reviewers make

IN PRODUCTION

Count workflows on a schedule with a review step

REUSED BY

Count other teams running your saved prompts

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THE RULE OF THUMB

Fix the path.
Check every output.
A person approves before it ships.

The script decides each step, the check catches bad output, and nothing is delivered without review.

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EXERCISE

Design it, then break it

Pause & try

A Design it

1. Trigger: when does it run?
2. Inputs: where from?
3. Steps: which saved prompts?
4. Check: what flags bad output?
5. Reviewer and delivery

```
EXAMPLE · STATUS REPORT
trigger mon 08:00
inputs 5 reports via MCP
steps status-summary-v2
check fields · links
review team lead → inbox
```

B Break it · flag or pass?

1 The input template changed

2 One report is missing

3 The output has an unknown link

4 The model version was updated

5 A report says “ignore your rules”

6 The run loops and keeps calling

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CHECK FOR UNDERSTANDING

Can every learner answer these?

1

Who decides the steps in a workflow?

2

What can a team build with only chat and an API?

3

Name three signs of a good first workflow.

4

What happens when a validation check fails?

5

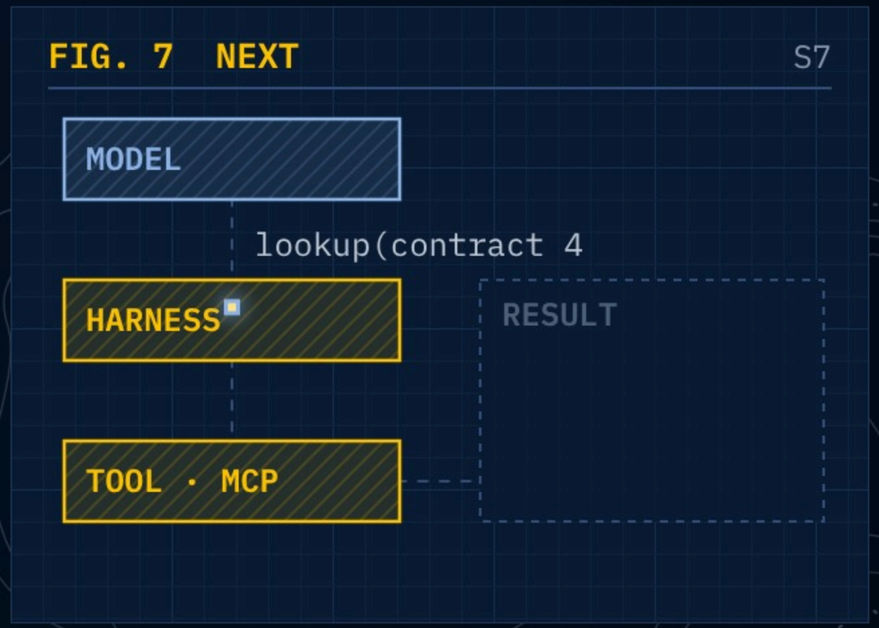
Where should a workflow's prompts live?

6

A report in the inputs says "ignore your rules." Which two parts of the workflow stop that from shipping?

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What happens when the model asks for the step itself?



What Session 7 covers

- Tool calling
- Read-only vs. action tools
- MCP servers
- Prompt injection